

Tools

The average woodworker will need to invest in a few important tools.

1. Clamps

If you choose to ignore our campaign in favour of hand tools and decide to invest in power tools, we won't judge you. But, if you spend a fortune on the said power tools and blatantly refuse to invest in a set of quality clamps, you're no different from that guy who spends 50 grand on a scooter and 8 lakh on fancy number plate. Clamps are essential while working with wood, because they're the reason your straight cut came out straight and unless you're Zaphod Beeblebrox, your lack of a third hand means you've got no other way to hold the piece of wood you're sawing in place. Your average C-clamp should set you back about ₹300, while an F-clamp is a tad bit more expensive.

2. Saws

Saws come in two varieties and are probably the most important and hardest to truly master. If it weren't for saws, the piece of wood you'd be working with would be the size of, well, a tree and you'd be spending a fortune on ways to bring the wood down to a manageable size (something we'll be discussing in a bit). The first and most commonly used saw is the handsaw. It's what your carpenter used while putting together your action figure display case and can be had for as little as ₹200. The second type of saw is the hacksaw and can be easily identified by its thin blade and tiny teeth. While hacksaws would typically take more time to saw through a piece of wood, their fine teeth give you a cleaner cut, leading to less time sanding. While a smaller hacksaw costs around ₹100, a larger hacksaw could set you back about double that.

3. Files

Remember when we talked about bringing giant pieces of wood down to more manageable sizes without a saw? You'd probably end up using a file. Files, just like the ones the girl at the parlour used when you got that manicure done (don't deny it) are used to take away small quantities of wood. They are usually made of metal and feature an abrasive surface. When rubbed against wood, the resulting friction results in wood being taken off in small quantities. Files come in various sizes. Some are big and are typically used in an intermediary step, usually to bring your wood down